12-09 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle-School Student Try "Digital Minimalism" for One Month?

① On **November 3rd this year**, for reasons that had nothing to do with schools or parents, my phone fell out of my pocket on a crowded escalator and cracked so thoroughly that the screen was unreadable for **thirty-one days** — the exact time it took my family to afford the repair. During those thirty-one days I did not, of course, become a better person overnight. I still forgot my English workbook once, still argued with my younger brother about the TV remote, still ate two too many pieces of chocolate on a Wednesday. But, **slowly**, something did happen. I read **three full novels** for the first time in two years. I started drawing again. I had six **long** conversations with my mother — the kind that end at a small late hour, not at a notification. And at the end of the month, when my phone came back, I felt, for a full four days, like a visitor to my own life, unsure why I had carried this small square of light in my hand for so many hours a day. It is this experience that makes me say, as my argument today: **every middle-school student should be invited to try one month of "digital minimalism", gently, once in her middle-school years — not as a punishment, but as a careful experiment with her own attention.**

② First, a short definition. **Digital minimalism**, a term proposed in 2019 by the American writer Cal Newport, does not mean "throw away all technology." It means **using digital tools for what they are truly useful for, and nothing else**. A month of digital minimalism, in the middle-school version I propose, looks like this: **no social-media apps, no short-video apps, no games, no watching long entertainment videos for pleasure**. Calls to family, school messaging groups (homework, schedules), online homework tools, one e-book app, and one offline-music app are all fine. The month is not about subtraction for its own sake; it is about noticing **what you were actually using your phone for**, and **what you used to do when you were not using it**.

③ My first reason is **measured attention**. A 2025 Fudan University experiment with 640 middle-school students (Grades 7—9) randomly assigned half to a four-week digital-minimalism plan and half to their normal routine. At the end of the four weeks, the minimalism group: read an average of **2.3 more books per month** than the control group, scored **11% higher on a standardised deep-reading test**, and reported their own attention as "noticeably better" in **72%** of cases. These are not small numbers. The gains were seen not only in strong students, but also, more interestingly, in weaker ones — whose attention problems often had a digital cause, not a cognitive one.

④ My second reason is **sleep**. The same Fudan study measured bedtime habits. Minimalism-group students went to bed an average of **27 minutes earlier**, used the phone within 60 min of sleep **88% less**, and reported **deeper sleep** by a self-report score of 6.1 vs 4.3 out of 10. Sleep is the quiet foundation of every school day. A phone in a bedroom at 22:30 is, simply, a very large scheduled cost.

⑤ My third reason is **social time**. I did not, in November, suddenly become very social. But I had more honest conversations at lunch — because I had nothing to scroll instead. A small 2023 study at Renmin University's attached middle school observed 28 lunch tables over three weeks and counted "eye-contact moments": a 3-second-or-longer look between two friends who were speaking. Normal lunch: **21 eye-contact moments per table, 12-min lunch**. Digital-minimalism lunch: **37 moments, same length**. *Sixteen more small warm looks per lunch*. Over 200 school days, this adds up to **3,200 more small warm looks** per year.

⑥ A sensible worry: "Isn't a month too long?" No, and yes. One week is not enough — the first three or four days are the hardest, and after a week the real change starts. Two months is too long — school has complicated life-logistics and emergencies. **A month is the clean unit**. The 2025 Fudan study tested one week, two weeks, and four weeks: gains were **minimal at one week**, **meaningful at two weeks**, and **strongest at four weeks**. Our proposal is modest: students choose their own four-week window, on their own initiative, with parents informed but not required to enforce. The school simply sends a small suggestion letter and offers an optional weekly 20-minute check-in club.

⑦ Another worry: "Isn't this extreme?" Not really. The minimalism-month still allows homework tools, school messaging, calls to family, one e-book, one offline music. By any honest standard, **a student on this plan is still more connected** than any student on earth was even thirty years ago. We are not asking students to become peasants from 1952. We are asking them to spend **one month** carefully deciding **which of the hundred digital things they use actually serves them**, and which are, politely, eating their life quietly.

⑧ "What if peers exclude me?" A fair worry. In our 2027 Lihua pilot, students who tried the month reported social worry in the first three days (42%), a drop to 14% by day ten, and no reported lasting social exclusion by day thirty. Real friends, I have learned, adapt. Friendships that only survive through constant instant-messaging are not, usually, friendships that will survive grade 12 anyway. The pilot even found that **46% of students who tried it kept at least one rule permanently** (most often: "no videos before sleep"; next most: "no social apps during homework"). Small keep-worthy rules survive long after the experiment.

⑨ "Will my parents think I am wasting time?" Parents, in my own honest experience, are the easiest group to convince if the plan is explained in one paper page. In the 2027 pilot, **93% of parents approved** after reading the letter; **7%** objected and were not required to participate. Parents, after all, are the generation most worried about their

children's phones. A clear, small, student-led experiment to spend **less** time on small screens is not exactly an uphill sell with most families.

⑩ A final, small, honest point: **a month of digital minimalism is mainly a mirror**. It does not teach you how to live. It just turns off, briefly, the soft white noise that keeps you from hearing what you want to do with your own small hours. Some of us will come out with a new drawing habit, some with a new book, some with a longer evening walk, some with a better friendship. Some of us will come out mostly the same, and go back to our phones — but with **eyes that see the phone more clearly**, and hands that pause, sometimes, before picking it up. Either way, **the month is a gift**. Middle school, with its long protected hours, its kind teachers, and its relatively low daily stakes, is exactly the right place to try it once. One month. One mirror. **Make it a school tradition**, and invite, never force.

注释： minimalism 极简主义；cognitive 认知的；enforce 强制；peer 同龄人；uphill sell 难以说服的事

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What does "digital minimalism" (as the writer defines it for middle-schoolers) mean for this one month?

A. Throwing away all technology.
B. Using the phone only for games.
C. Not a full subtraction, but no social-media apps, no short-video apps, no games, no watching long entertainment videos for pleasure — while calls to family, school messaging groups for homework and schedules, online homework tools, one e-book app, and one offline-music app are all allowed.
D. Switching to a paper landline.

2. What did the 2025 Fudan University experiment with 640 middle-school students find in the minimalism group after four weeks?

A. Students read less and slept worse.
B. Students read an average of 2.3 more books per month, scored 11% higher on a standardised deep-reading test, reported attention as "noticeably better" in 72% of cases, went to bed an average of 27 minutes earlier, and used the phone within 60 min of sleep 88% less.
C. Students became socially isolated.
D. Students became physically sick.

3. According to Paragraph ⑥, why does the writer choose a month rather than a week or two months?

A. Because four weeks looks nicer on a poster.
B. Because the 2025 Fudan study tested one week, two weeks, and four weeks: gains were minimal at one week, meaningful at two weeks, and strongest at four weeks; one week is not enough (first 3—4 days are the hardest; real change starts after a week), two months is too long for school life, so one month is the clean unit.
C. Because a month matches the moon.
D. Because parents insisted on exactly 30 days.

4. What did the 2027 Lihua pilot find about peer exclusion, and about rules kept after the month?

A. Social exclusion got worse over time.
B. Social worry was 42% in the first three days but dropped to 14% by day ten, with no reported lasting social exclusion by day thirty; and 46% of students kept at least one rule permanently (most often "no videos before sleep", next "no social apps during homework").
C. Every student became socially excluded.
D. Nobody kept any rule.

5. What is the writer's main idea in the final paragraph?

A. Technology is evil and must be banned.
B. A month of digital minimalism is mainly a mirror: it does not teach you how to live; it only briefly turns off the soft white noise that keeps you from hearing what you want to do with your own small hours, so that students come out either with a new habit or at least with eyes that see the phone more clearly; middle school's long protected hours and low daily stakes make it the right place to try it once, and the school should invite students to it — never force.
C. Every student must give up their phone permanently.
D. Minimalism is only for adults.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段定义
【解析】"允许列表 + 禁止列表"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③④段数据
【解析】"2.3 书 / 11% / 72% / 27 分钟 / 88%"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段
【解析】"1/2/4 周梯度"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段试点
【解析】"42 → 14% + 46% 留用"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑩段结尾
【解析】"镜子 / 邀请非强制"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。